The media trial had already condemned Geelani, so it did not come as a surprise that on 18 December 2002 the designated court condemned my brother to death. The scene outside Patiala House Court in Delhi could have been a scene from a Bollywood film. In the courtroom three Kashmiris were being sentenced to death, and lawyers were shouting, ‘Death to the lawyers who defend terrorists’. Outside the court, Shiv Sena hooligans were bursting crackers to celebrate.

The 296-page judgement by the trial court was summarized into a poem of twenty-nine lines taken from the judgement in a poster entitled ‘Logic of an Anti-Terrorist Court’. The poster was part of an exhibition entitled ‘Lies of Our Times’, telling the story of Geelani’s trial by the All India Defence Committee for S.A.R. Geelani. I am reproducing the poem here:

Terrorism is a scourge of all humanity
Terrorism is sponsored by rogue states
Rogue states are mostly ruled by religious fanatics
Rogue states are despotic and fundamentalist

Terrorists use religious fanatics and modern technology
Fanatics get financial and strategic support from Pakistan
Pakistan is waging war against India
The attack on Parliament was an act of waging war on India
The five men who attacked Parliament were Pakistanis
They were Pakistanis because they looked like Pakistanis Pakistan is indulging in cross-border terrorism

This cross-border terrorism is in Kashmir
Three accused are Kashmiris from Baramulla
Therefore the three of them are terrorists

Terrorists are enemies of the country
Enemies cannot be given the protection of our Constitution
Constitutional protection need not be given to Geelani
Geelani is a Kashmiri Muslim and a brilliant scholar
Educated people are hired by terrorists
Therefore Geelani must have been hired by terrorists
Terrorists are enemies of the state
Enemies need not be given a fair trial

It is unpatriotic to disbelieve the police or their witnesses
Even if the police are telling lies they do so in the national interest
In the national interest the media also suppressed the truth
It is even more anti-national to believe the defence witnesses
Even if defence witnesses are known for their loyalty to the Indian Constitution
National interest can be served only if people accused of terrorism are hanged
Geelani must be hanged, terrorism must be ended.[20]